AI IN INDUSTRY

Where AI earns its keep

Hi readers, where does AI earn its keep? This month we look at four decisions it can help people make, from choosing the right size online to deciding which power line a crew should check first.

THE SHORT VERSION

In this issue

Retail. Virtual try-on, shopping assistants, and tools that help staff keep shelves stocked.

Healthcare. Who pays for imaging AI, why companies buy imaging platforms, and how AI-assisted screening could free up specialist time.

Fintech. Ramp's latest funding round puts a price on its push to automate company spending.

Infrastructure. Percepto's Axion helps teams turn drone and sensor data into maintenance priorities.

01 RETAIL

Retail AI goes to work

Will this jacket fit? Which products are about to sell out? This month's retail updates show how AI is helping shoppers and store teams make those everyday decisions.

A fitting room for online shoppers

In October, fashion technology company **CATCHES** brought its PredictiveFit virtual try-on to **THE OUTNET**. It uses the retailer's existing product data to show shoppers how a garment could fit in different sizes before they buy. [1]

The early numbers come from a separate deployment of **RealFit at AMIRI**. CATCHES compared six months before and after launch. It adjusted the purchase rate and gross sales figures for seasonality using similar AMIRI styles. [1]

AMIRI REALFIT · CATCHES-REPORTED RESULTS [1]

+55%	+56%	−30%
Purchase rate	Gross sales	Fit-related returns

For retailers, the opportunity is to help shoppers pick a size with more confidence while cutting the cost of returns. THE OUTNET's rollout is a chance to see whether similar gains carry over to PredictiveFit.

Shopify speeds up inventory questions

A merchant can ask **Sidekick**, Shopify's assistant, which products are running low. Sidekick hands the job of looking up store data to a specialized model based on NVIDIA Nemotron 3.5 Lightning. Shopify says that for this task the model responded **7× as fast** and cost **about 90% less to run** than its general-purpose benchmark. Merchants can get stock information sooner when deciding what to reorder. [2]

Shopping assistants move into texts and aisles

Amazon began inviting selected U.S. shoppers to text **Alexa for Shopping** on November 6. They can ask it to find and compare products, build a cart, place an order, or check delivery. [3]

Walmart expanded **Sparky** in October. It can suggest products from a photo, turn a handwritten shopping list into a cart, and guide customers to the right aisle. [4]

Both updates could remove steps between finding an item and buying it. The announcements describe what shoppers can do and leave the sales impact of the new features open. [3, 4]

AI spots shelf problems while staff can still fix them

Seekr is rolling out software that analyzes shelf images to more than **4,000 associates** at a merchandising company that serves over **40,000 retail locations**. The tool flags misplaced products and gaps that can be hard to spot, so associates can decide what to fix before leaving the store. [5]

From shelf check to same-visit fix

1. **Check the shelf.** The associate uses the app during a store visit.
↓
2. **Flag the issue.** The software spots and prioritizes potential problems.
↓
3. **Confirm and act.** The associate checks the alert and fixes what they can on the spot. [5]

What to watch. Retailers can test virtual try-on at scale by comparing returns per order across similar products. For shelf alerts, the measure to watch is how often staff resolve a problem on the first visit.

Research window · October 8–November 7, 2026. Performance figures come from company disclosures.

02 HEALTHCARE

The business of imaging AI

Imaging AI has three ways to make a business case. Insurers can help pay for it, patients can pay directly, or providers can use it to free up specialist time.

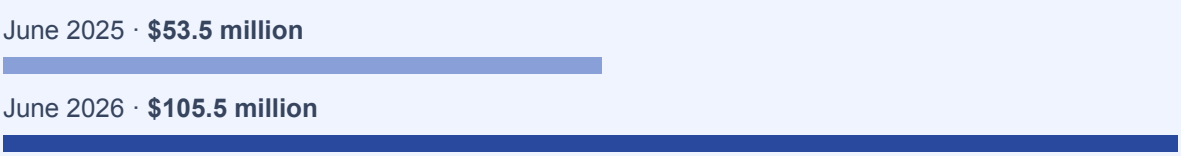
Who pays

Since October 1, hospitals have been eligible for a temporary Medicare add-on when they use **Aidoc** to flag urgent CT scans in qualifying inpatient cases. That same day, Medicare contractor **Palmetto GBA** proposed declining coverage in its region for automated brain MRI measurements. **Everlywell** took a different route, offering **Clairity's** mammogram-based risk assessment for **$249** out of pocket. [6–8]

What companies are buying

Agilent agreed to pay **$240 million** in cash for **Proscia**, plus up to $30 million in milestone payments, for software that connects lab equipment, records, and AI tools. **RadNet's** proposed **ONRAD** acquisition would let it offer imaging, AI software, and remote radiologist services together. [9, 10]

RadNet Digital Health annual recurring revenue



Growth included acquisitions and gains from new and existing customers. Source · RadNet Q2 2026 Form 10-Q [11]

Commercial case · AI-assisted mammography

Sweden's MASAI trial found that using AI to decide which mammograms needed a second reader cut the number of readings by **44%**. In a separate rollout, **Lunit** expects its software to support **200,000–250,000 exams a year** across Stockholm once fully deployed. For providers, the test is whether the specialist time saved justifies licensing and integration costs while maintaining screening quality. [12, 13]

03 FINTECH

Ramp’s $60 billion bet on AI for company spending

Ramp started with corporate cards. Now it’s building AI agents into the work that follows each purchase, from checking receipts to closing the books. Its latest funding round puts a **$60 billion** price on that broader business. [14]

What happened

On October 15, Ramp announced a **$1.85 billion** round led by Dragoneer, with Thrive Capital and Founders Fund among the co-leads. Fidelity and T. Rowe Price also participated. Four months earlier, Ramp raised $750 million at a $44 billion valuation. [14, 15]

Ramp’s valuation at three private transactions



Up 362% overall since March 2025. Bar labels show the change from the previous milestone. Percentages are rounded.
March 2025 was a sale of existing shares. June and October 2026 were funding rounds. [14, 15, 19]

What the agents do

Ramp’s agents can take steps in purchasing, expense review, and accounting. They can help match receipts to transactions and check spending against company rules. Finance staff can then focus on flagged charges and decide which exceptions to approve. Ramp also offers cards that agents can use to make purchases within spending limits, and **Glass**, an October launch that lets coworkers share prompts and workflows. [14–18]

What the valuation assumes

Ramp reported crossing **$2 billion in annualized revenue** over the summer, up from roughly $700 million in March 2025. Annualized revenue expresses a recent sales pace as a yearly figure. From March 2025 to the October round, its valuation rose about **4.6×**. Over roughly the same stretch, its reported revenue run rate grew about **3×**. Using $2 billion as the benchmark, the October valuation was about **30× annualized revenue**. To justify that price, Ramp needs to keep growing as customers test whether agents save time without loosening spending controls. [14, 19, 20]

04 INFRASTRUCTURE

AI takes infrastructure inspection to new heights

A drone can photograph a transmission tower without sending someone up it. Once the images come back, someone still has to work out which signs of damage warrant a closer look.

What Percepto launched

On October 27, **Percepto** introduced **Axion**, a subscription platform that can analyze data from supported drones and sensors operators already own, alongside past inspection records. Percepto says Axion uses **more than 160 specialized AI models** to flag problems such as a downed wire or an unusual heat pattern. Its inspection experts validate the findings before sending reports to operators. [21, 22]

From inspection to maintenance decision

1. Capture. Bring in drone images, sensor readings, and past inspection records.

↓

2. Flag and verify. Axion identifies potential defects and inspection experts check the findings.

↓

3. Decide. Maintenance teams choose which issues need a field visit, a repair, or continued monitoring. [21, 22]

Where it could pay off

Percepto also announced a multi-year deal to collect aerial data and analyze transmission lines for a U.S. energy company. For operators, using existing equipment could lower the cost of adopting the software. Earlier alerts could cut review time, help crews avoid unnecessary visits to hazardous areas, and give them time to act before a fault causes downtime. [21]

What to watch. Comparing repeat inspections could help engineers spot deterioration sooner. Operators can test the value by tracking time from inspection to decision, unnecessary site visits, and unplanned downtime.

THE TAKEAWAY

What this means

Retailers can judge AI by sales and returns. Imaging providers can weigh specialist time saved against the cost of the software. Finance teams can track how much paperwork agents take on and which transactions still need human review. Infrastructure operators can check whether faster reviews lead to earlier repairs and fewer outages. In each industry, the business case gets clearer when teams measure what changes in their day-to-day work.

Sources

1. CATCHES · October 22, 2026. PredictiveFit launch and AMIRI RealFit results (Business Wire release)
2. Shopify Engineering · October 21, 2026. How Shopify turns open models into task experts
3. Amazon · November 6, 2026. Alexa for Shopping by text
4. Walmart · October 30, 2026. Sparky's holiday shopping updates
5. Seekr · October 30, 2026. Retail shelf inspection case study
6. Aidoc · August 13, 2026. Medicare add-on payment eligibility for CARE Body CT Multi-Triage
7. Palmetto GBA / CMS · October 1, 2026. Proposed local coverage decision on automated brain MRI analysis
8. Everlywell · October 1, 2026. Nationwide launch of Clairity Breast through Everlywell
9. Agilent · October 13, 2026. Proposed Proscia acquisition
10. RadNet · October 26, 2026. ONRAD acquisition agreement
11. RadNet · Q2 2026. Form 10-Q and Digital Health performance
12. Lång et al., The Lancet Oncology · 2023. MASAI reading workflow and workload analysis
13. Lunit · September 28, 2026. Planned rollout of a second reader across Stockholm
14. Ramp · October 15, 2026. October financing and annualized revenue
15. TechCrunch · October 15, 2026. October funding and comparison with the June round
16. Ramp · Product documentation. Purchasing controls and cards for agents
17. Ramp · October 13, 2026. Glass launch announcement
18. Ramp Help Center · Product documentation. How agents and finance staff review card transactions
19. Ramp · March 3, 2025. March 2025 share sale and valuation
20. TechCrunch · September 9, 2025. Annualized revenue, including the March 2025 figure reported by Ramp's CEO
21. Percepto · October 27, 2026. Axion launch and transmission inspection contract
22. Percepto · Product documentation. Axion inspection workflow and expert validation

Fieldnotes · Written by Siddharth, Mohammed, Akash, and Estanislao · November 2026